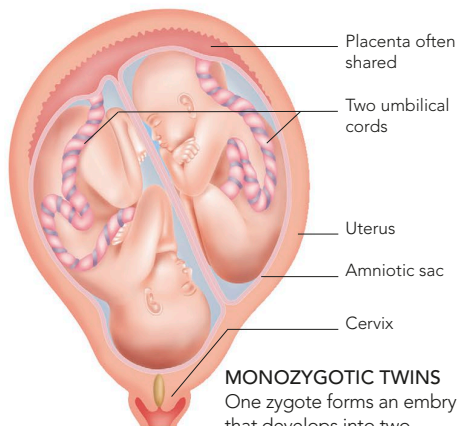


PREPARING FOR BIRTH

CHANGES DURING LATE PREGNANCY SIGNAL THE APPROACH OF CHILDBIRTH. THE HEAD OF THE FETUS DROPS LOWER INTO THE PELVIS; THE EXPECTANT MOTHER MAY EXPERIENCE WEIGHT LOSS; AND THERE MAY BE EARLY UTERINE CONTRACTIONS.

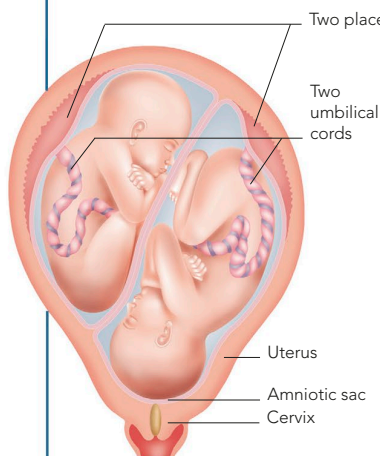
MULTIPLE PREGNANCY AND FETAL POSITIONS

The presence of more than one fetus in the uterus is called a multiple pregnancy. Twins occur in approximately one in 80 pregnancies, and triplets in about one in 8,000. After about 30 weeks, the most common fetal position is head down, facing the mother's back, with the neck flexed forward. Such a position eases the baby's passage through the birth canal. However, about 1 in 30 full-term deliveries is breech, in which the baby's buttocks emerge before the head.



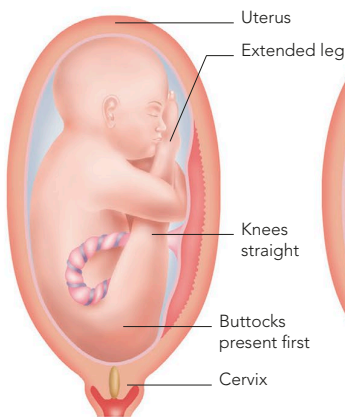
MONOZYGOTIC TWINS

One zygote forms an embryo that develops into two fetuses that have the same genes and sex and often share one placenta. They are "identical" twins.



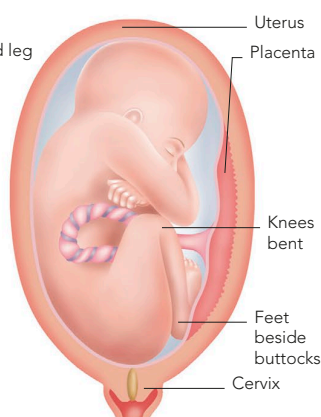
DIZYGOTIC TWINS

Two zygotes develop separately, each with its own placenta. They may be different or the same sex. They are "fraternal twins" and are like any brothers and sisters.



FRANK BREECH

The baby fails to turn head-down in the uterus. The hips are flexed and the legs are straight, extending alongside the body so that the feet are positioned beside the head.



COMPLETE BREECH

The legs are flexed at the hips and knees, so the feet are next to the buttocks. The incidence of breech delivery is much higher among premature babies.